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Winchester School of Art

MA Communication Design

ARTD 6280 — Outputs (Making)

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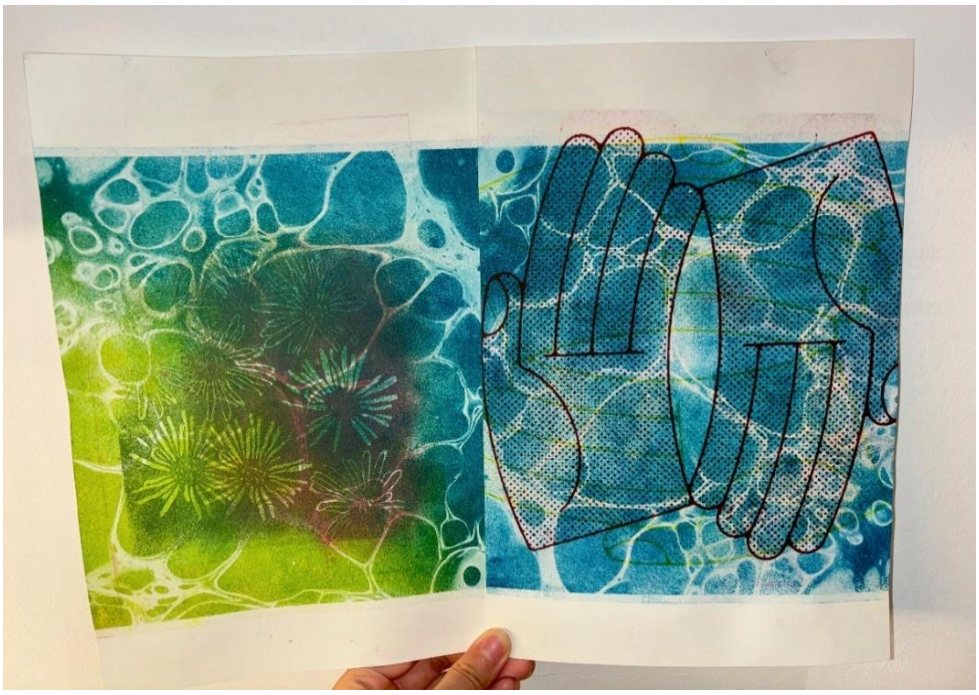
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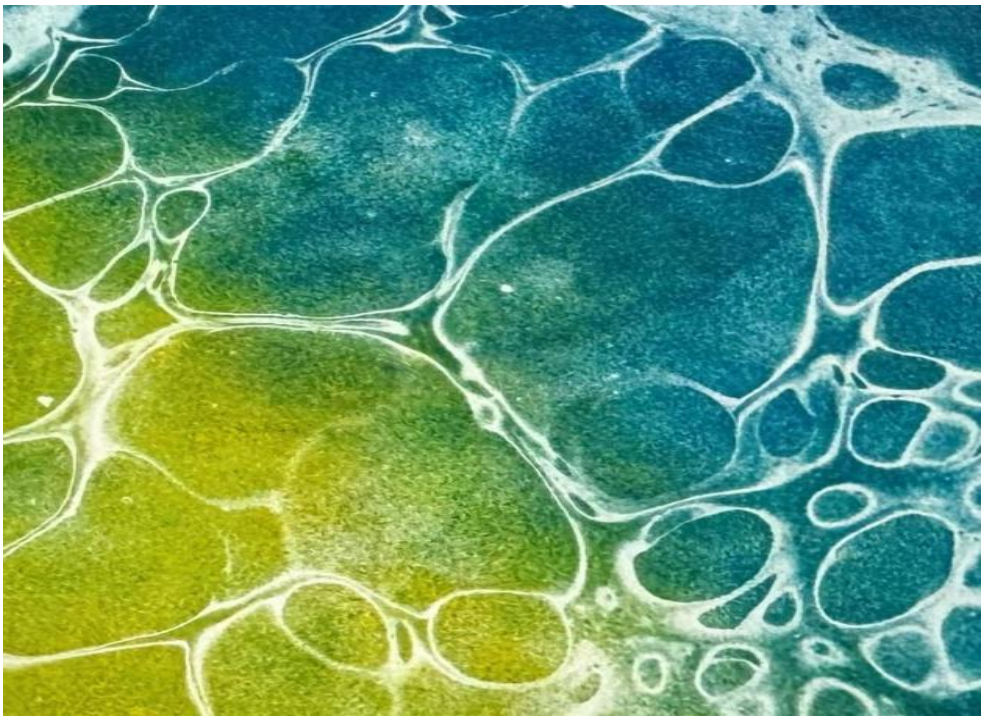
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1. Workshop Outcomes

1.1 Photocopy Litho- Lithography images & process, Reflection

Final Artifact





Process Documentation

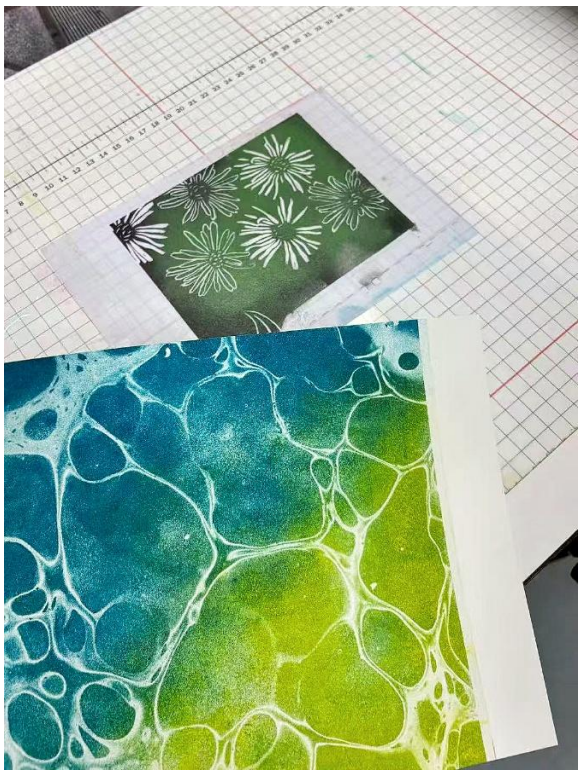


The ink is applied to the image for transfer. An adhesive ensures the printed image adheres smoothly to the surface.



The paper is placed into the machine for pattern transfer. The prepared paper must be carefully placed in the machine to ensure that the pattern adheres correctly to the final surface. The machine also checks the pressure and alignment to avoid

misalignment or deformation.



Waiting for the transfer

Reflection

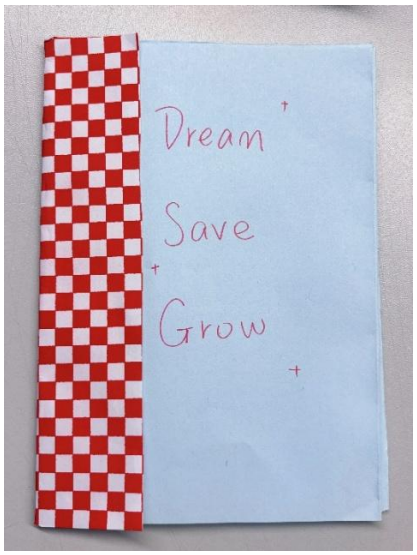
This was my first attempt at offset transfer printing. While I had done some rubber stamp work before, both techniques required a certain level of skill. However, photosensitive resin transfer seemed easier to grasp because it didn't require particularly intricate carving, yet it was also more appealing. Initially, I was worried about making mistakes with the colors, so I sought guidance from Andy. He suggested I experiment boldly; only by trying could I experience the process and enjoy the results. This gave me the courage to try mixing colors, even though the workshop initially focused on monochrome techniques.

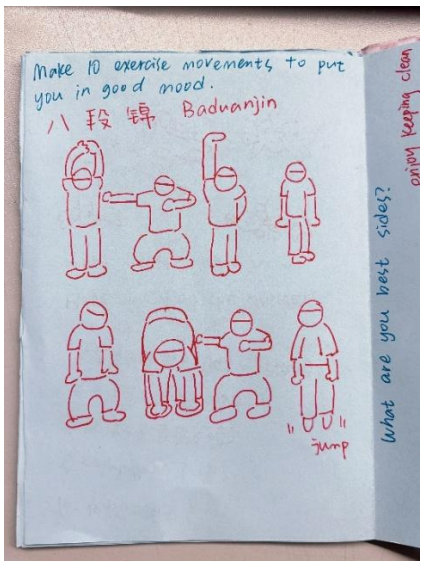
To my surprise, Andy pointed out that my multi-color transfer was an innovative method, likely employing color layering or overlapping techniques.

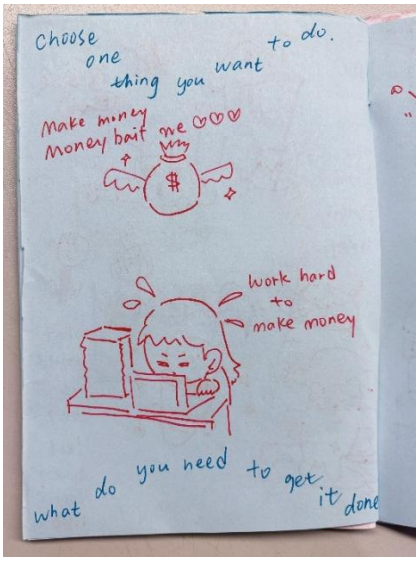
Although I didn't think the effect was perfect and didn't meet my expectations, I persisted in trying different layering methods and color combinations. Working with my classmates at the same table, supporting and learning from each other, made the whole process much more enjoyable. Overall, this experience encouraged me to conduct more creative experiments and made me appreciate the value of exploration in design.

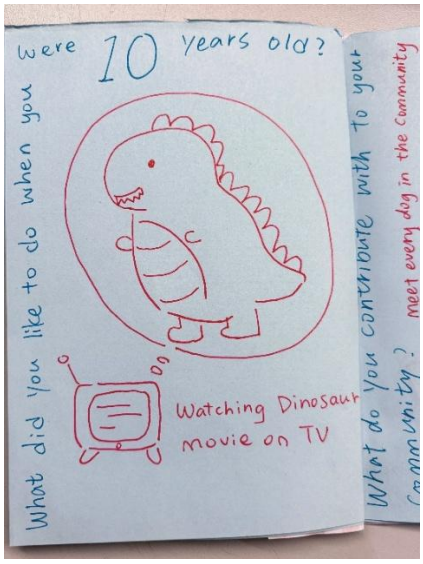
1.2 One-Page Booklet Workshop- images& process, Reflection

Final Artifact – Selected Pages & Booklet Overview

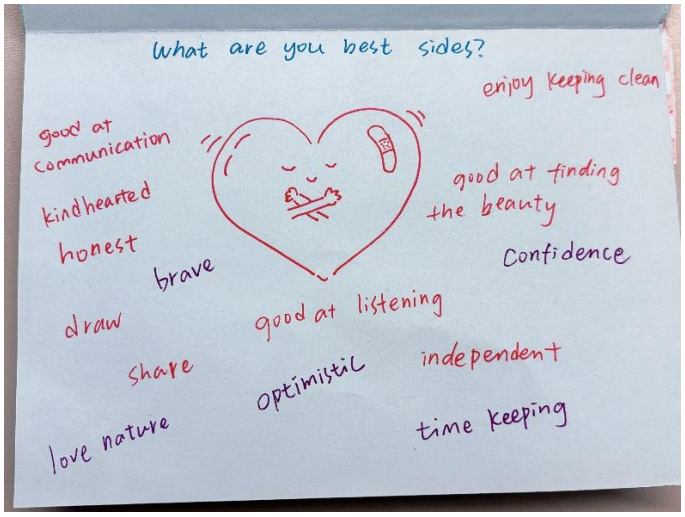




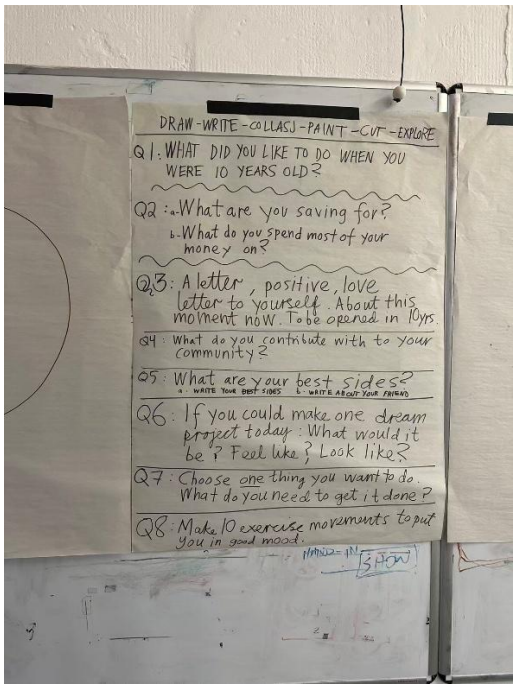




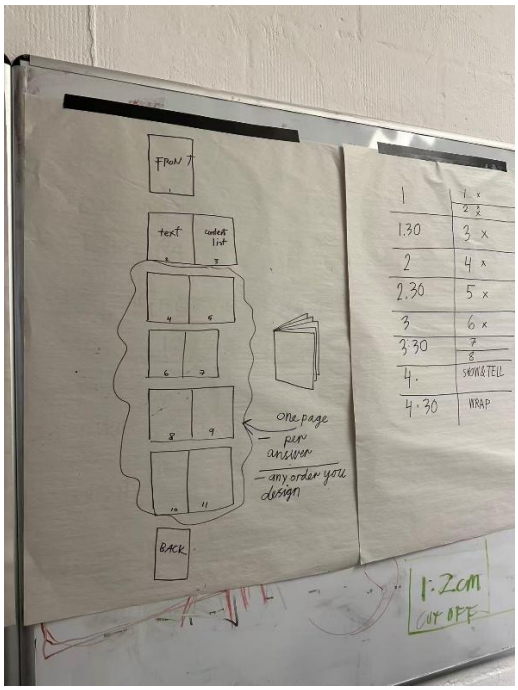




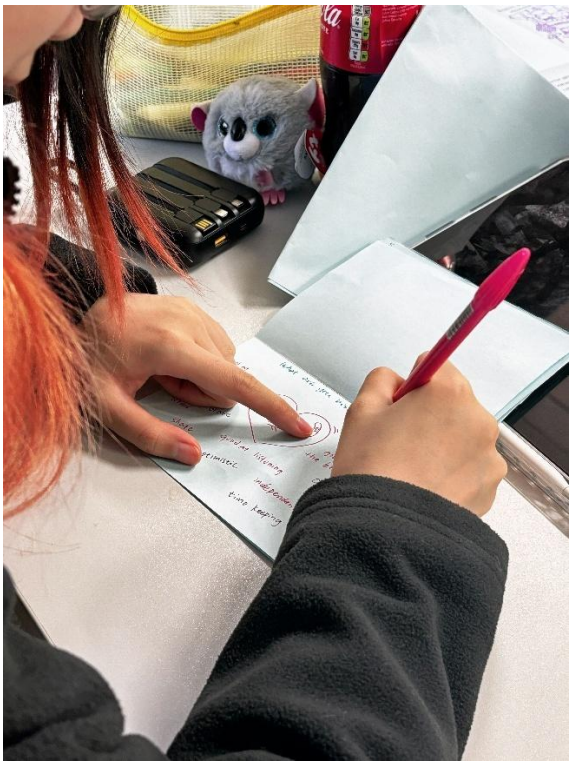
Process Documentation



Self-Expression Guidance Checklist



Guide to Creating Booklets



Creative process

Reflection

Creating this 12-page booklet was a completely free process of expressing my ideas—my mentor advised me to "not overthink, just draw," so I named the cover "Dream, Save, Grow." The entire creative process was very enjoyable, but it made me think about many things, cleverly blending practice with personal reflection. From "Imagining Your Future Self" to "Revisiting Childhood Hobbies," the workshop prompts guided me to connect past experiences, current habits, and long-term aspirations. This made the creative activity transcend simple crafting and become a very meaningful endeavor.

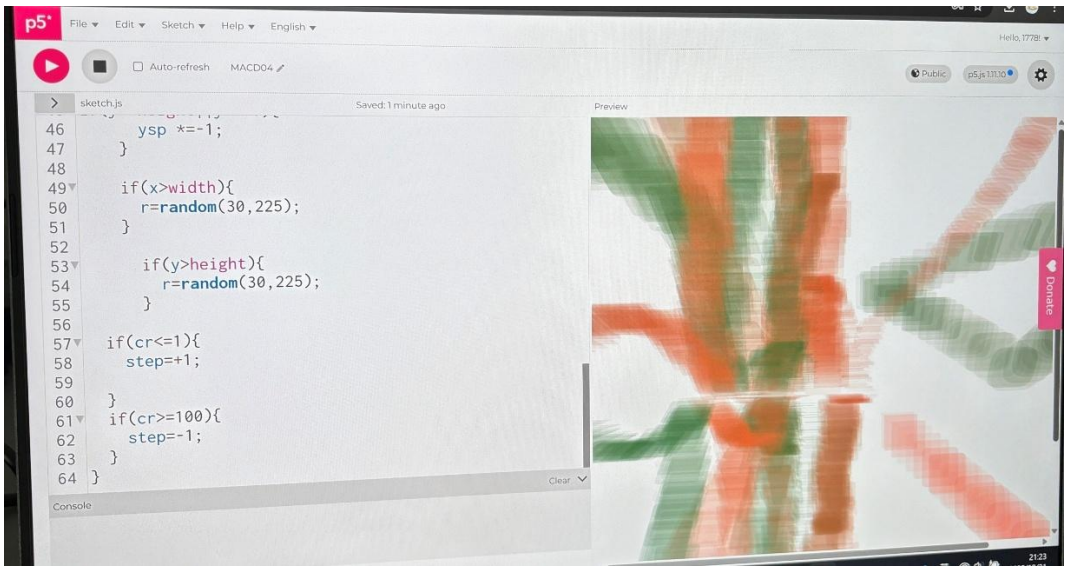
Our group had red and white graph paper that the other groups didn't have. I used it to make binding strips to decorate the cover—this small change added a tactile and handcrafted feel to the booklet, while also subtly echoing our

shared workshop experience. Another detail is that on the "Ten Mood-Boosting Exercises" page, I used simple lines to draw the traditional Chinese exercise "Eight Pieces of Brocade," incorporating cultural elements in a lighthearted and fun way. The students' feedback on me and my feedback on them made this booklet a vehicle for collaborative exchange, giving it an unexpected emotional resonance.

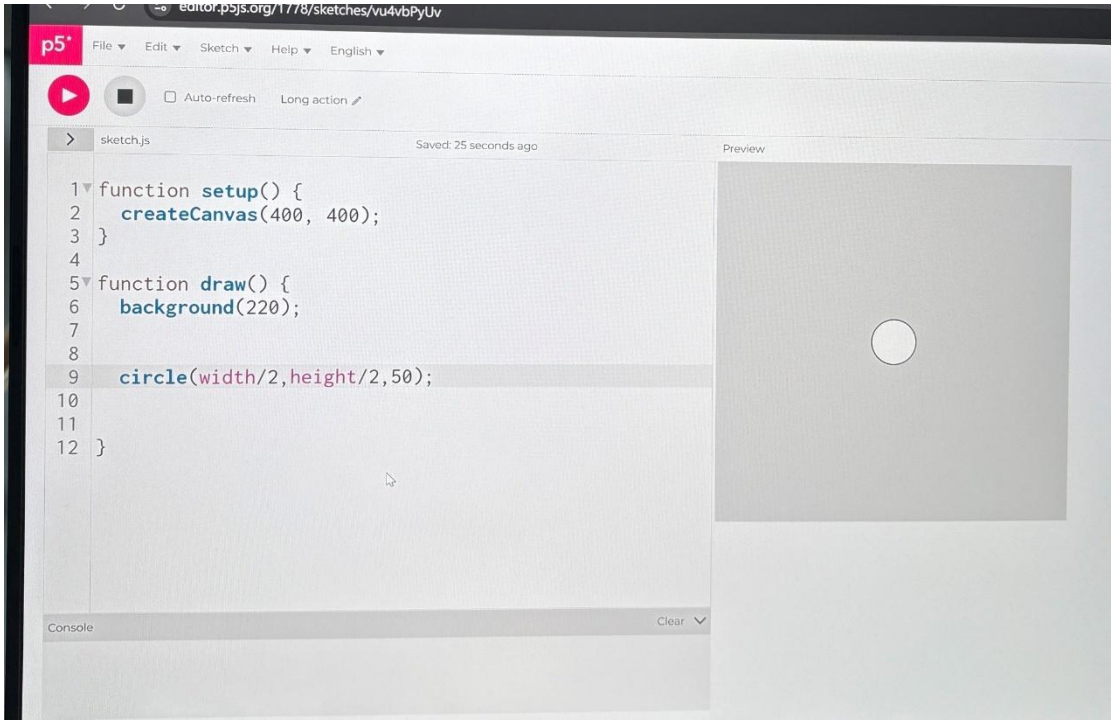
Although my photographs only document a portion of the creative process, they helped me trace the journey from initial inspiration to the final piece. Overall, this workshop deepened my understanding of the unique value of slowing down, creating by hand, and exploring myself through visual expression. This booklet has ultimately become a small yet profound record of my life—a distillation of my current state, my values, and the direction I aspire to take.

1.3 Creative Coding with p5.js screenshots & process, Reflection

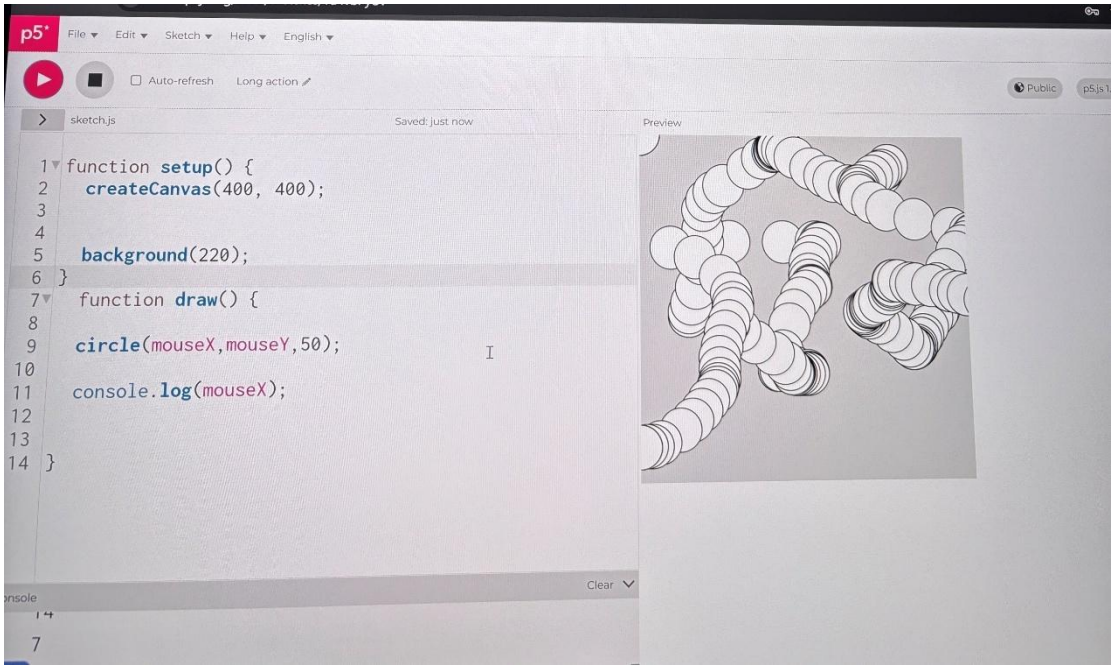
Work-in-Progress



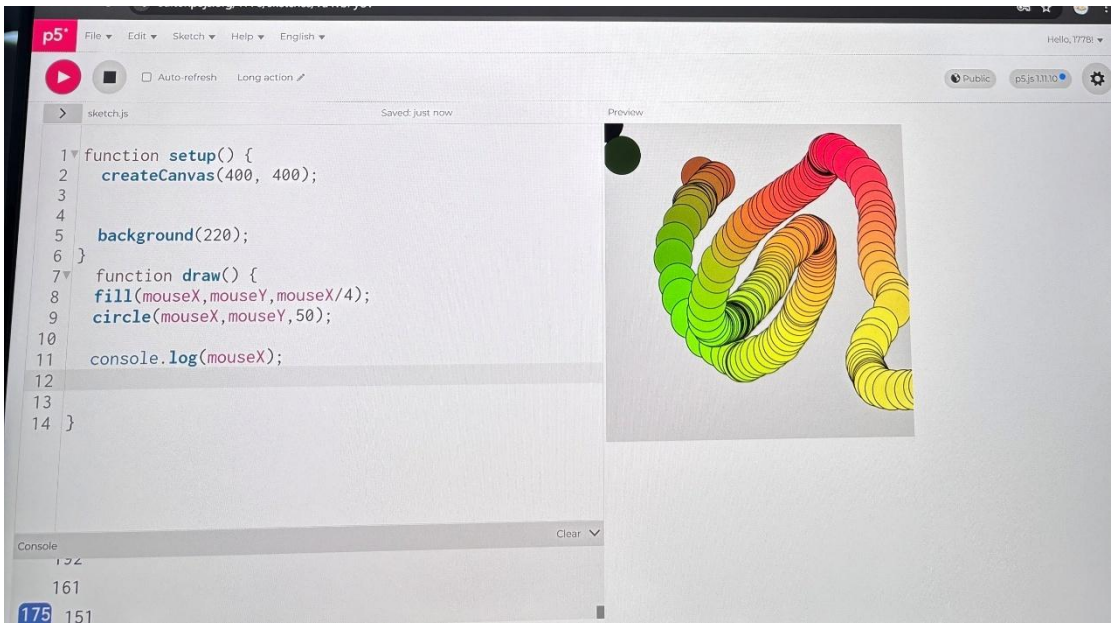
Process Documentation



In the initial stages of programming, complete the basic code for creating the canvas and determining the center of the circle.



By optimizing the code by binding the circular coordinates to the mouse position, an interactive effect of "drawing a circle when the mouse moves" is achieved, thereby generating a continuous graphic trajectory.



Adjust the logic of the parameters controlling the size of the circle and the fill color so that the size and hue of the graphic can change synchronously with the mouse position, ultimately producing a dynamic visual effect full of tension.

Reflection

This p5.js programming exercise allowed me to gradually explore the entire process from static graphics to interactive visual effects. Initially, I found understanding the instructor's explanations quite challenging, and the process was somewhat confusing. However, through step-by-step learning and independent experimentation, I gradually mastered the key concepts and functions, highlighting the importance of persistence and iterative learning.

Initially, I could only draw circles in fixed positions. By binding coordinates to the mouse and adjusting color and size parameters, I achieved responsive interaction—no easy feat! The randomness of the parameters meant that simple data changes could produce drastically different visual effects, demonstrating that code can be both a set of rules and an open container for expression.

The real-time visual feedback of p5.js fundamentally changed my perception of programming—it was no longer a tedious mechanical operation, but a captivating art form: seeing graphic changes immediately after writing just a few lines of code was incredibly fascinating. The final animated graphics were more than just finished products; they documented my "trial and error-adjustment-retry" process. Although I encountered considerable obstacles at first, this experience deepened my understanding of the value of trial and error. It also made me truly realize that technical skills and creative expression complement each other—technology is the tool, and creativity is the core.

2. Design Dialogue Lecture Reflections

2.1 Lecture01 Holly Wales

Holly Wales's lecture was a comprehensive and insightful exploration of professional illustration, emphasizing daily practice, interdisciplinary exploration, and process-oriented creation. Having studied graphic illustration as an undergraduate, I deeply resonated with this. Her use of inexpensive felt-tip pens and experimentation with various drawing styles demonstrated how limitations can foster a unique visual style. Through her major projects, such as weekly contributions to *The New York Times* and involvement in public advocacy campaigns, I gained a deeper understanding of how to balance personal creative exploration with professional responsibility. This lecture inspired me to combine the techniques I learned with Holly's process-oriented approach. In the future, I may explore new expressive techniques in illustration projects to develop a unique visual language

2.2 Lecture02 Aya Haidar

Aya Haidar's lecture left a deep impression on me, especially her approach to storytelling through experimental textile art. Her works, using materials such as secondhand shoes, discarded clothing, and fabrics, carry the power of narrative, conveying the experiences and personal histories of refugees. Her projects documenting the contributions of women in community centers demonstrate empathy, resilience, and social engagement. What impressed me most was her ability to balance emotional connection with critical awareness. In telling complex stories, she avoids exploiting suffering while maintaining profound reflection. Listening to her lecture deeply moved me and gave me a deeper understanding of how narrative techniques, material selection, and creative context intertwine to create profound meaning in art. This lecture inspired me to consider how to integrate personal or historical narratives into my creative practice and explore how to combine craftsmanship with digital technology to enhance the emotional impact and social influence of narratives.

2.3 Lecture03 Darren Raven

What impressed me most about Darren Raven's talk was his commitment to posting twelve pages of Instagram content daily. This reminded me of my own habit of regularly creating posters. After following his Instagram account, I was amazed by the incredible regularity of his updates. This demonstrates how consistent effort can gradually shape a unique style. His openness to AI-powered creative tools was particularly beneficial. I also believe that technology should enhance, not replace, human creativity, and I plan to cautiously explore the application of AI in my own practice.

The talk also emphasized the importance of structured processes and continuous input, rather than sporadic bursts of inspiration. This aligns perfectly with my working philosophy. This approach reminds me of the "conditional design" methodology I once studied. Digital tools should be used as experimental aids, not replacements. In conclusion, this talk inspired me to cultivate disciplined, regular creative habits, explore iterative processes, and integrate digital and manual methods into my design practice.

3. Overall Critical Reflection

In the Output (Making) course, I primarily participated in three types of workshops and three types of lectures, forming my own insights, which deepened my understanding of communication design. The course was not simply about listening to lectures and mechanically replicating processes; rather, it was a learning format that integrated practice and theory. It not only cultivated my multi-dimensional reflective abilities and critical thinking, but the lectures also connected the learning content with social realities, career development, and social responsibility, allowing me to further reflect on my future development plans and social responsibilities beyond practical application.

Through participation in lithography, creative programming using p5.js, and a 12-page brochure workshop, I was exposed to many unfamiliar tools and technologies, challenging my existing understanding. These experiences resonated with lectures by Holly Wales, Darren Raven, and Ayah Haider, prompting me to think more deeply about how designers balance digital media and craftsmanship. Each practical session, and each inevitable failure, deepened my understanding of how intuition, discipline, and iteration shape

creative outcomes. Similarly, these lectures broadened my understanding of the ethical, stylistic, and cultural dimensions of design, emphasizing the importance of critical engagement, not just technological application. I gradually realized that achieving a balance between technology, creativity, and humanistic values is not a static goal, but an evolving practice that requires continuous refinement through ongoing creation, reflection, and a keen awareness of the world around us.

When I first attended a lithography workshop, I felt unfamiliar with this format and, being naturally hesitant to try new things, I struggled with color selection within the limited class time. I asked the instructor, Andy, for advice, but he told me to "believe in yourself" and that only through hands-on experience could I truly understand the process and the outcome. However, as the workshop progressed, I gradually realized that this unpredictability wasn't a limitation, but rather an opportunity to embrace intuition and explore unexpected results. This experience taught me to enjoy the process and made me realize that perfection isn't everything; simply "starting" is the most important thing.

The second workshop I'd like to introduce is the booklet creation workshop. I greatly admire the instructor—she's a successful practitioner of combining art and commerce. She not only has solid painting skills and has created numerous murals, but he also consistently enjoys the creative process. Her core advice to us was, "Don't overthink it, just draw." This precisely addressed my dilemma of "thinking too much and finding it hard to start," and it also helped everyone quickly immerse themselves in the creation process. During the creation process, the instructor inspired us through a series of guiding questions: from recalling our preferences at age 10 to writing a letter to

ourselves ten years from now. She helped us organize our thoughts by weaving together the past and future, inspiring our vision for the future, and requiring us to "draw whatever comes to mind."

Our group was fortunate; we had unique grid paper on the table that the other groups didn't have. I cut out a small piece to decorate the booklet and even extended it to the cover, adding a touch of ingenuity to this entirely handmade booklet. In the booklet, I drew a short illustration for the theme of "How to Relax," presenting the traditional Chinese health exercise "Eight Pieces of Brocade" in a cute style. I also had a new idea: if I create similar works in the future, I'd like to try collage techniques and use natural, recyclable materials to make the pieces more innovative. This experience also deepened my understanding of the course: intuition and improvisation are truly crucial in design.

The last workshop was a programming workshop, which was very challenging for me. At first, I couldn't keep up with the instructor's demonstrations at all and was completely confused. But I didn't give up. I followed the pace, practicing repeatedly step by step, and also discussed with classmates. Slowly, I figured it out and truly understood the importance of perseverance.

At first, I could only create a stationary circle on the drawing board. Later, by following the steps and adjusting, I could not only change the size and color of the circle, but also make it move with the mouse, move on its own, and even control its dynamic changes with levers. Although programming was tedious at first, and I often encountered program errors and unresponsive screens, the joy of success when I saw my code bring the graphics to life was

incredibly strong. This experience also taught me that early trial and error is meaningful, and perseverance will lead to results.

In selecting lectures, I chose three creators who most interested me for in-depth observation and reflection. Each shared their philosophies, methods, and practices from different perspectives. This not only resonated with my experiences in the workshops but also prompted me to think more deeply about the essence of design.

Holly Wales' illustration lecture was one of the first I attended. Because I enjoy drawing and my undergraduate tutor was also skilled in graphic design, I was initially very interested in this lecture. Her sharing during the lecture was very inspiring. For example, her experience practicing drawing with inexpensive, sharp pens during my student days made me realize that creation doesn't have to be picky about tools; as long as you want to express yourself, you can convey your ideas. Behind her varied drawing styles was a solid foundation, which pointed out my problem—I hadn't practiced enough to find my own style.

She also mentioned her experience collaborating with renowned companies like the New York Times, where clients constantly adjusted their requirements, making me understand that designers need resilience. The philosophy she conveyed also coincided with the core of the previous workshop: don't strive for perfection, just start creating, enjoy the process, and don't worry too much about "whether it's right or wrong," because intuition can bring unexpected surprises. Finally, she mentioned that "the essence of design is problem-solving," which made me deeply understand that artistic creation doesn't rely

on expensive tools, but rather on curiosity, a desire to explore, and perseverance. In the future, when doing illustration or art creation, I will use "think less, do more, and correct in the process" as my core approach. This lecture was incredibly beneficial.

What impressed me most about Darren Raven's lecture was his habit of creating 12 visual works every day. He showed us his Instagram account, and after following him, we found that he does indeed update posters and other content daily, with beautiful color schemes and a consistent style. Behind this efficiency lies the accumulation of over 20 years of design education experience and his dedication to treating daily creation as "cognitive training." He has maintained this rhythm for over 300 consecutive days, and I deeply admire his perseverance.

He made me truly understand the concept of "quantitative change leading to qualitative change": the seemingly effortless daily updates become increasingly valuable over time, not only accumulating aesthetic appreciation and making creative logic more coherent, but also confirming that "creation stems from clear beliefs and goals, not just simple passion." This also made me reflect on myself—persisting in something is not easy; I often give up due to unexpected situations, fatigue, and pressure, leading me to consider how to balance creation, rest, and mental and physical health. True creative self-discipline doesn't rely on an "inexhaustible wellspring of inspiration," but rather on establishing a workable rhythm—for example, breaking down "12 sketches a day" into "small sketches completed in short bursts of free time." This allows creation to become a natural extension of life without sacrificing physical and mental health. This prompted me to consider how to design a "flexible and

sustainable" creative plan based on my own schedule, balancing practice intensity with rest needs and avoiding giving up due to overexertion.

He also mentioned that creativity cycles between "inspiration, fatigue, and perseverance," and embracing this cycle is key to continuous growth. His teaching philosophy is similar to "conditional design," emphasizing "free expression within a defined framework." This aligns perfectly with my previous programming training and booklet creation logic, giving me a more coherent understanding of course design: whether it's the technical training in workshops or the conceptual sharing in Lectures, they all guide us to understand the "dialectical relationship between constraint and freedom," and Darren's practice provides the most vivid example of this concept—true creative freedom stems precisely from a deep understanding and flexible application of rules.

Overall, this course has given me many core insights for working in the design industry: learning to embrace the unpredictability of creation, trusting my intuition, daring to challenge myself and not giving up easily, and understanding the importance of finding a balance between commercial needs and creative expression, sustainable concepts and practical operations, and creative discipline and freedom of expression. These gains have also deepened my overall understanding of the essence of communication design.